my life passed a much more miserable twenty four hours than from the time I left Tabreez until I arrived at Ahar. In the first place I started fresh out of Tabreez and therefore felt the fatigue of travelling and was pretty well tired with riding the first stage thro' a sandy salt country and under a burning hot sun, altho this stage was only six fursungs (24 miles). Then when I arrived there about 12 o'clock, noon day, I could get no room except one in which there was a man, his wife, several children, three hens sitting upon eggs, a calf and a wounded sheep and chickens coming in and going out ad libitum. The place smelt close and disagreeable but I was tired and wanted to get out of the sun and as the man spread a perfectly new and clean carpet for me I thought I might escape without fleas. I threw myself down upon the carpet and slept for some hours. When I awoke I found that I had several fleas about me and I sat outside intending not to go into the house again. However towards sun down there came on one of those tremendous storms of rain and thunder and lightning which are only to be seen in these mountain districts. I was of course driven into the house. That however I found unbearable and when the rain abated a little I went out and sat on the wet ground with my cloak about me and the rain falling fast. In this position I remained some two or three hours and tried to sleep for the rain had swollen the mountain torrents so much that the villagers told me, to proceed in such a dark night as that, was next to impossible. The fleas, the smell from several hundred head of cattle which had now returned from their pastures for the night and the steam rising from the wet earth prevented my sleeping, and about eleven o'clock I started again having hired a guide for the sum of two sailcroons (2/) to go with me until daylight. I did not find the waters so much out as I expected but I was so sleepy that I could scarcely sit on my horse and at last I was obliged to stop and piquetting the horses amongst the grass I lay down upon the wet ground pulled my cloak over my head and had about an hours good sleep. I had had scarcely any sleep the night before and that and coming out of the town made me feel these little inconveniences the more. Had I been some days travelling I should have minded the rain etc. very little. On arriving in camp the man at whose tents I stayed had a seperate tent pitched for me, to which I retired and after undergoing a complete purification changing all my clothes and eating a good breakfast I was all right again. The few days I remained in camp I spent pleasantly enough, that is to say considering the anxiety I was in about news from Charles.

The camp was pitched about three miles S. W. of Ahar on a pretty grassy plain with a small stream running thro' it and a mountain, which was high enough to retain some of its snow even at this season, overhanging it. I went to Ahar once. It is a small Persian country town and I should think contained

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